Uttar Pradesh Sports Policy: Creating a Stronger Sporting Ecosystem

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched the UP Sports Policy 2023, his administration stopped treating sports as an afterthought and began investing in an athlete's entire life cycle. The policy also widened the definition of competitive sport, making Uttar Pradesh the first state in India to formally include e-sports in an official sports policy.

Supporting Talent Before the Podium

CM Yogi ji is mandating that financial support must start at the village level. He tied this to the "One District One Sport" (ODOS) framework, mapping specific sports to all 75 districts. The framework also supports the coaches delivering this training, with ODOS coaches across all 75 districts receiving a monthly honorarium of ₹25,000.

Because of this intervention, the state is now actively disbursing annual stipends of ₹75,000 for junior athletes and ₹50,000 for sub-juniors. The policy also sets clear financial rewards for athletes who reach the highest levels, with individual Olympic gold medallists eligible for ₹6 crore, silver medallists ₹4 crore and bronze medallists ₹2 crore, alongside separate rewards for team events and medals at the Asian Games, Commonwealth Games and World Cups. To protect athletes long-term, the administration also rolled out a monthly pension scheme for senior national-level athletes.



Narendra Modi
Prime Minister of India

A Sporting Ecosystem That Creates Careers

The Chief Minister decided that sporting glory must translate into long-term professional security. He structurally changed state recruitment rules to reserve executive government careers for international medal winners.

Recent Asian Games gold medallists like cricketer Deepti Sharma and athlete Parul Chaudhary, alongside international shooter Akhil Sheoran, were directly appointed as Deputy Superintendents of Police (DSP). By personally handing out these joining letters, Adityanath established a reliable, functioning pipeline from the stadium to public service.





POLICY AT A GLANCE

- **Grassroots Support:** ₹75,000 annual assistance for juniors; ₹50,000 for sub-juniors.
- **Coach Support:** ₹25,000 monthly honorarium for ODOS coaches across 75 districts.
- **Medal Rewards:** Up to ₹6 crore for an individual Olympic gold medal, with separate awards for silver, bronze, team events and other major competitions.
- **Health Cover:** ₹5 lakh cashless insurance for athletes and coaches.
- **Injury Support:** Dedicated Eklavya Sports Fund for injury treatment.
- **Career Security:** Gazetted government appointments (e.g., DSP) for international medallists.
- **Development Fund:** ₹100 crore initial corpus for specialized training and equipment.
- **Elite Infrastructure:** 14 Centres of Excellence and 5 High-Performance Centres rolling out statewide.
- **E-sports:** First state in India to formally include e-sports in an official sports policy.

Creating Elite Infrastructure and Medical Safety

Elite athletes previously had to leave the state to find world-class facilities or risk career-ending debt over injury treatments. Adityanath tackled both bottlenecks. To secure athletes' physical futures, he mandated a ₹5 lakh cashless health insurance cover. The policy also created a dedicated Eklavya Sports Fund specifically for injury treatment, separate from the broader UP Sports Development Fund. To fund elite preparation, he established the UP Sports Development Fund with an initial ₹100 crore corpus.

Today, athletes have direct access to foreign training camps, physiologists, and psychologists without paying out of pocket. Simultaneously, the state is rolling out 14 Centres of Excellence and 5 High-Performance Centres, ensuring that Uttar Pradesh's best athletes can train, recover, and build their careers entirely within the state.